

The Daily Whispers

13th APRIL 2026

Kenya Equity Market

SECURITY NAME	YTD	CURRENT PRICE	TARGET PRICE	UPSIDE (%)	INVESTMENT RATIONALE	RECOMMENDATIONS
Equity Group Holdings	▲11.2%	74.25	93.49	▲25.9%	• Announced historic FY2025 results with a 54.7% surge in Profit After Tax to KES 75.55 Bn, driven by growth in the Kenyan banking unit and significant contributions from regional subsidiaries. • Enhanced shareholder value through a 35.3% increase in dividend payout to KES 5.75 per share, supported by a fortified balance sheet that expanded 9.2% to KES1.97 Tn.	**BUY**
Co-operative Bank	▲29.0%	30.90	33.38	▲8.0%	• Reported a 16.9% rise in net profit to KES 29.75 Bn for FY2025, underpinned by a successful "Soaring Eagle" transformation that moved over 90.0% of customer transactions to digital and alternative channels. • Achieved a 23.0% growth in net interest income to KES 29.40 Bn, reflecting dominant market share in the SME and MSME segments which now represent 17.0% of the bank's total loan portfolio.	**BUY**
BAT Kenya	▲24.6%	572.00	609.41	▲6.5%	• BAT delivered 17.0% y/y growth in net earnings to KES 5.25 Bn, supported by a 14.6% reduction in operating costs, highlighting strong cost discipline. • The tobacco sector remains exposed to tight regulation and taxation, which may constrain long-term demand growth. • Expansion of modern oral nicotine pouches is expected to drive future growth.	**HOLD**
ABSA Bank Kenya	▲25.1%	30.90	31.39	▲1.6%	• Absa delivered 9.7% y/y growth in PAT to KES 22.91Bn, primarily driven by a 31.8% decline in loan loss provisions, highlighting improving credit performance and disciplined risk management. • Net interest income declined 6.4% y/y to KES 43.29Bn, reflecting moderating lending yields and margin normalization amid easing interest rates.	**HOLD**
Sasini Plc	▲52.0%	27.20	27.20	-	• Earnings remain sensitive to fluctuations in global tea, coffee, and macadamia prices, which can affect revenue stability. • The sale of the avocado processing plant signals a retreat from a decade-long strategy to diversify leaving the company heavily reliant on the highly volatile tea and coffee sectors.	**SELL**

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Global Market

SECURITY NAME	YTD	CURRENT PRICE	TARGET PRICE	UPSIDE (%)	INVESTMENT RATIONALE	RECOMMENDATIONS
Snowflake Inc (SNOW) EX: NYSE	▼44.8%	121.11	237.89	▲96.4%	• Accelerating demand for cloud-native data analytics solutions is driving 30.0% revenue growth, with 6,100 customers now deploying AI features and a robust backlog supporting multi-year growth visibility. • Strategic partnerships and a strong innovation cadence differentiate Snowflake in a consolidating enterprise data platform market.	**BUY**
Astera Labs Inc (ALAB) EX: NASDAQ	▼10.4%	149.05	202.75	▲36.0%	• Astera Labs' high-growth data center connectivity portfolio delivered 115.0% revenue growth and best-in-class gross margins, capitalizing on surging demand for advanced solutions. • Leadership in PCIe 6.0 interoperability, robust product pipeline, and strategic positioning in hyperscale infrastructure underpin outsized earnings momentum and sustained market share gains as AI workloads proliferate.	**BUY**
UnitedHealth Group (UNH) EX: NYSE	▼7.8%	304.33	360.96	▲18.6%	• UnitedHealth's diversified model, strong cash generation, and efficiency initiatives offer resilience and margin recovery potential amid Medicare Advantage headwinds. • 33-year dividend streak, robust capital returns (16Bn to shareholders), and strategic leadership changes reinforce long-term value creation despite recent regulatory scrutiny and sector volatility.	**BUY**
Costco Wholesale Corp (COST) EX: NYSE	▲15.8%	998.47	1067.94	▲7.0%	• Costco's membership model, global network expansion, and double-digit growth in membership income and e-commerce are fueling steady top-line gains and industry-leading renewal rates. • However, a premium valuation and potential margin headwinds from normalizing gas prices and interest rates suggest limited near-term upside relative to retail peers.	**HOLD**
SanDisk Corporation (SNDK) EX: NASDAQ	▲258.8%	851.77	825.05	▼3.1%	• Despite a meteoric 2,564.0% one-year price run and strong AI data center exposure, SanDisk faces negative margins, ongoing operational challenges, and large goodwill impairments. • Management guides for continued supply-demand imbalances and margin pressure through 2026, with strategic pivots toward enterprise SSDs and next-gen BiCS8 tech unlikely to offset near-term earnings risk at current valuation extremes.	**SELL**

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